# Elite Workout Manual

# Chapter 2 – Upper Day (Strength + Hypertrophy)

## Objective

Develop upper-body strength while building muscle, improving posture, and progressing toward your first strict pull-up. This session prioritizes heavy compound lifts early, followed by targeted hypertrophy work and corrective exercises.

## Session Structure

| Order | Exercise | Sets | Reps | RPE | Rest | Tempo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Barbell Bench Press | 4 | 5–8 | 8 | 2–3 min | 2-1-X-1 |
| 2 | Chest-Supported Row | 4 | 6–8 | 8 | 2–3 min | 2-1-1-1 |
| 3 | Incline Dumbbell Press | 3 | 8–10 | 8 | 90 s | 2-1-1-0 |
| 4 | Lat Pulldown (Pull-up Grip) | 3 | 8–10 | 8 | 90 s | 2-1-1-1 |
| 5A | Cable Lateral Raise | 3 | 12–15 | 8–9 | — | 2-1-2-1 |
| 5B | Face Pull | 3 | 12–15 | 8–9 | 60 s after pair | 2-1-2-1 |
| 6A | Incline DB Curl | 3 | 10–12 | 8 | — | 2-1-2-0 |
| 6B | Rope Pushdown | 3 | 10–12 | 8 | 60–75 s | 2-1-2-0 |
| 7 | Dead Hang | 3 | 20–40 s | — | 60 s | Controlled |

## Pull-up Progression

Perform 2 sets of 8–10 scapular pull-ups before lat pulldowns. Finish with controlled dead hangs. Once you can perform slow negatives for 5–8 seconds, begin assisted pull-ups.

## Why This Order?

Heavy pressing and rowing are performed first while fresh to maximize strength gains. Hypertrophy work follows, then supersets for shoulders and arms to save time without reducing compound lift performance.

## Execution Cues

Bench: feet planted, shoulder blades retracted. Row: drive elbows toward hips. Face pulls: pull to eye level with external rotation. Dead hangs: keep shoulders active, not completely relaxed.

## Common Mistakes

Skipping warm-up sets, rushing heavy lifts, swinging during pulldowns, excessive shrugging on lateral raises, and training every set to absolute failure.

## Progression

When every working set reaches the top of its rep range with 1–2 reps in reserve, increase the load by the smallest available increment the following week.